

# Ahwon Cho

Senior UX / Visual Designer · Enterprise Platforms · End-to-End UX

ahwony82@gmail.com · 224.255.9630 · [linkedin.com/in/ahwon-c-3bb41593](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ahwon-c-3bb41593) · [ahwony.com](https://ahwony.com)

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Senior UX and Visual Designer with 10+ years of end-to-end product design experience across enterprise, B2B, and customer-facing software platforms. Experienced in conducting user research, usability testing, and direct customer interviews to inform design decisions. Currently working side-by-side with engineers and stakeholders at Microsoft's Surface Commercial team, designing tools for IT admins and enterprise customers. Skilled at translating ambiguous needs into wireframes and high-fidelity UI, presenting solutions to everyone from end users to VP-level stakeholders. Comfortable bridging design and engineering through hands-on QA collaboration, design-to-code guidance, and AI-assisted rapid prototyping.

## CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

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| <b>UX &amp; Interaction</b> | Wireframes, user flows, prototyping, usability testing, end-to-end product design                                                          |
| <b>Visual Design</b>        | Typography, color, spacing, iconography, high-fidelity UI                                                                                  |
| <b>Design Systems</b>       | Component libraries, Figma Auto-layout, UI toolkits, design language consistency at scale                                                  |
| <b>Accessibility</b>        | WCAG standards, inclusive design principles, collaborating with accessibility partners                                                     |
| <b>Vibe Coding</b>          | Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, VS Code Copilot, Copilot CLI, and Google Antigravity — fast prototyping, concept validation, and vibe coding |
| <b>Design Tools</b>         | Figma (primary), Framer, Adobe Creative Cloud                                                                                              |
| <b>Front-End Basics</b>     | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React — working knowledge for design-to-dev handoff and lightweight prototyping                                     |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### UI/UX Designer (Contract)

Microsoft — Surface Commercial Team · Aug 2023 – Present, Redmond, WA

- Leading end-to-end UX design across multiple enterprise projects, working side-by-side with engineers and PMs to build tools for IT admins and enterprise customers — including a Copilot integration project.
- Owning the full design lifecycle for the Surface IT Toolkit: IA, user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, and a custom icon set — performing design QA with engineers to ensure implementation quality.
- Modernizing internal and external portals through systematic UI revisions, challenging design limitations and ensuring responsive, accessible experiences.
- Presenting design solutions and compelling product stories to senior stakeholders, aligning cross-functional teams across design, engineering, and product management.
- Mentoring designers and guiding engineers on design implementation, contributing to a culture of quality and craft within agile sprint cycles.

### Sr. UX Designer (Contract)

The Home Depot · Sep 2022 – Mar 2023, Atlanta, GA

- Supported Home Depot Protection Plan (HDPP), AAFES, and B2B Pro Checkout teams — creating high-fidelity design comps within a new enterprise design system.
- Developed responsive, Auto-layout-driven UI components in Figma ensuring optimal cross-device experiences.
- Delivered a full post-purchase HDPP flow end-to-end, coordinating between internal teams and Allstate stakeholders under tight resource constraints.
- Created comprehensive user flowcharts segmenting purchase and post-purchase stages for monetization strategy.

### UX Designer (Contract)

Microsoft · Mar 2022 – Aug 2022, Redmond, WA

- Contributed to a B2B management web application — producing wireframes and user flows for network infrastructure and chatbot features from ambiguous requirements.
- Developed scalable, modular design assets and storyboards that improved stakeholder alignment at VP level through structured storytelling.
- Participated in design critiques and review cycles, iterating with cross-functional teams to refine and align on solutions.

## Visual Interface Designer (Contract)

Blue Cross Blue Shield NC · Jun 2021 – Mar 2022, Durham, NC

- Led the B2B cost estimator web app project from concept to prototype — conducting usability testing with end users and delivering within a tight deadline.
- Created a full UI Toolkit, Figma component library, user flows, wireframes, and final UI designs for a mobile app.
- Translated ambiguous product briefs into clear visual designs; collaborated closely with content strategists, researchers, and dev teams to ensure successful delivery.

## Product Designer

Coco N Design · Jun 2020 – Mar 2021

- Designed end-to-end UX for PantryNote mobile app — persona development, IA, user flows, wireframes, and high-fidelity Figma prototypes.

## UX / UI Designer

SM Beauty (Kbeauty21.com) · Aug 2017 – Sep 2018, Schiller Park, IL

- Led e-commerce website and warehouse management web app A–Z — conducted direct customer interviews and gathered real-world product feedback from users to inform persona development, UX decisions, and visual design.

## UX / Visual Designer

SamsBeauty (Samsbeauty.com) · Aug 2016 – Jan 2017, Mt Prospect, IL

- Led e-commerce renewal — gathered direct customer and coworker feedback to identify UX problems, lifting the site to #1 in its category through improved flows and design system consistency.
- Managed B2B and B2C web and mobile app projects, revising user flows and resolving UX problems that improved conversion rates and customer satisfaction.

## UX / Visual Designer

Various Clients · Jan 2014 – May 2016, South Korea

- Delivered end-to-end UI/UX for mobile apps and responsive websites; built front-end code (HTML, CSS, Bootstrap) working directly alongside development teams.

## Visual Designer / Motion Designer

SK M&S; · Chai Communications · CNR M&C; · Jul 2008 – Jun 2011, South Korea

- Designed web and interaction assets for major Korean brands including Samsung Electronics and BC Card; built promotional websites and shopping mall platforms using CMS tools.

## EDUCATION

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**Maryland Institute College of Art**      Master's in UX Design · 2019–2020, Baltimore, MD

**Korea National Open University**      BA in Media Arts and Sciences · 2009–2011, South Korea

## ADDITIONAL

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Languages: English (fluent) · Korean (native)